Mile Marker #8: My Career Snapshot

One career. Honest research. Your real assessment of the fit.

You've done the research. This Mile Marker asks you to make sense of it: not repeat it, but honestly assess what you found and what it means for you.

It's also how the college assesses Professionalism (#6), one of the course's focus skills. That doesn't mean it needs to sound polished. It needs to sound like you, and be specific and honest.

Two parts, one file. Part 1 is your Career Research Guide. Part 2 is the three Mile Marker questions. Do the research first, then answer the questions. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes and save a PDF. Either way, upload this one file to the Mile Marker #8 assignment in Blackboard.

NAME _____ **CAREER I RESEARCHED** _____ **DATE** _____

Part 1: Career Research Guide

One career, researched well. Then an honest look at whether it fits you. Work through the five sections in order.

RESEARCH SOURCES

Career Coach: regional salary, job outlook, and OCTC programs (owensboro.lightcastcc.com)
O*NET OnLine: tasks, skills, work styles, and work context (onetonline.org)
Occupational Outlook Handbook: national pay and outlook (bls.gov/ooh)
Job postings on Handshake, Indeed, or Glassdoor: what employers are actually asking for

SECTION 1

The basics

Be specific. "Health care" isn't a career. "Registered Nurse" is.

Job title _____ **Industry or field** _____

Education and training required. Which program at OCTC, or elsewhere, gets you there?

Specific skills needed: technical skills, software, certifications, or licenses

Sources I used

SECTION 2

The numbers

Use Career Coach for regional numbers and the Occupational Outlook Handbook for national ones.

Salary range in our region

National median salary

Job outlook *(choose one)*

☐ Growing ☐ Stable ☐ Declining

What's driving the outlook? (For example: technology, an aging population, policy, automation)

SECTION 3

The reality of the work

This is what most career research skips: what the work actually looks and feels like day to day.

Typical work environment. Office, outdoors, clinical, remote, school, warehouse, lab, traveling?

Typical schedule and hours (days, nights, weekends, on call, flexible?)

Dress code (scrubs, uniform, business casual, casual?)

People load *(choose one)*

☐ Mostly solo work ☐ Small team or colleagues ☐ Heavy public, patient, or client contact

☐ Varies

Pace and pressure *(choose one)*

☐ High pressure, fast-paced ☐ Steady and predictable ☐ Highly variable

Physical demands. Sitting, on your feet, lifting, driving, traveling?

SECTION 4

The fit analysis

Connect what you found to what you know about yourself from Modules 3, 6, and 7.

Strengths: where do your HIGH5 strengths show up in the demands of this career? Be specific. Don't just list your strengths.

Values: where my values are honored

Values: where there may be friction

Work environment: how does the setting fit how you work best?

Pressure: how does this career's pace and pressure compare with how much pressure you handle well?

Academic path: how does the education this career requires connect to the direction you explored in Module 6?

Life management: how do the schedule, pace, and physical demands fit how you manage your time and energy now?

Overall fit *(choose one)*

☐ Strong fit ☐ Mostly fits, with some friction ☐ Mixed, needs more exploration

☐ Probably not right for me

SECTION 5

Your honest assessment

This section feeds straight into Part 2.

Three reasons this career interests you. Go deeper than "it pays well."

Reason 1

Reason 2

Reason 3

One area of alignment

One area of friction or uncertainty

One question I still have

Who or what could help me answer it?

BEFORE YOU WRITE

Synthesis

In two or three sentences: what do you know now that you didn't before, and what does it change about how you're thinking about your direction?

Part 2: Mile Marker questions

Use your research from Part 1. Keep it brief where the guide already has the detail.

QUESTION 1

What Did You Find?

Summarize the career in your own words: education required, regional salary, job outlook, and typical work environment. Keep it brief. The guide has the detail. This is the headline version.

***A strong answer** covers all four: education, regional salary, outlook, and work environment, in your own words.*

QUESTION 2

Does It Fit?

Connect your research to what you know about yourself from Modules 6 and 7.

***A strong answer** connects specific research findings to your strengths, your values, how you work best, and your pressure tolerance. Not just a list of your results.*

- Where do your strengths show up in this career?
- Where are your values honored, and where is there friction?
- How does the work setting fit how you work best?
- How does the career's pace and pressure compare with how much pressure you handle well?
- How does the day-to-day reality fit your life?

QUESTION 3

What's Your Honest Take?

Name one clear area of alignment and one area of friction or uncertainty.

***A strong answer** names one alignment and one friction, asks one specific question, and names a person or resource that could help answer it.*

One area of alignment

One area of friction or uncertainty

The one question I still need answered

Who or what could help me answer it